ITM MAHIDOL UNIVERSITY

Module 6

Value chain and ITIL management practices



Manutsiri Chansutthirangkool
CISSP, AAISM, CISM, CRISC, CEH, CHFI, ISO 27001 LI, ITILv4(f)

Syllabus

3.1 Introduction to ITIL Product and Service Lifecycle (all Assessment Criteria included)

3.2 Purpose of the ITIL Product and Service Lifecycle management activities (all Assessment Criteria included)

4.4 Value chain (all Assessment Criteria included)

4.5 Management practices (all Assessment Criteria included)



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What you will learn

By the end of this module, you will be able to:

- identify the purpose of each ITIL Product and Service Lifecycle management activity within the value chain
- recall key terms and definitions related to value chain activities
- explain how value chain activities are supported by management practices to enable value creation
- understand the role of management practices within the ITIL Value System
- explain the structure and benefits of the Official ITIL Practice Guides.



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The ITIL Product and Service Lifecycle

User and customer experience is shaped by the digital product and the service provider's system.

The lifecycle shows how organizations:

- capture needs and feedback
- design, build, deliver, and support services.

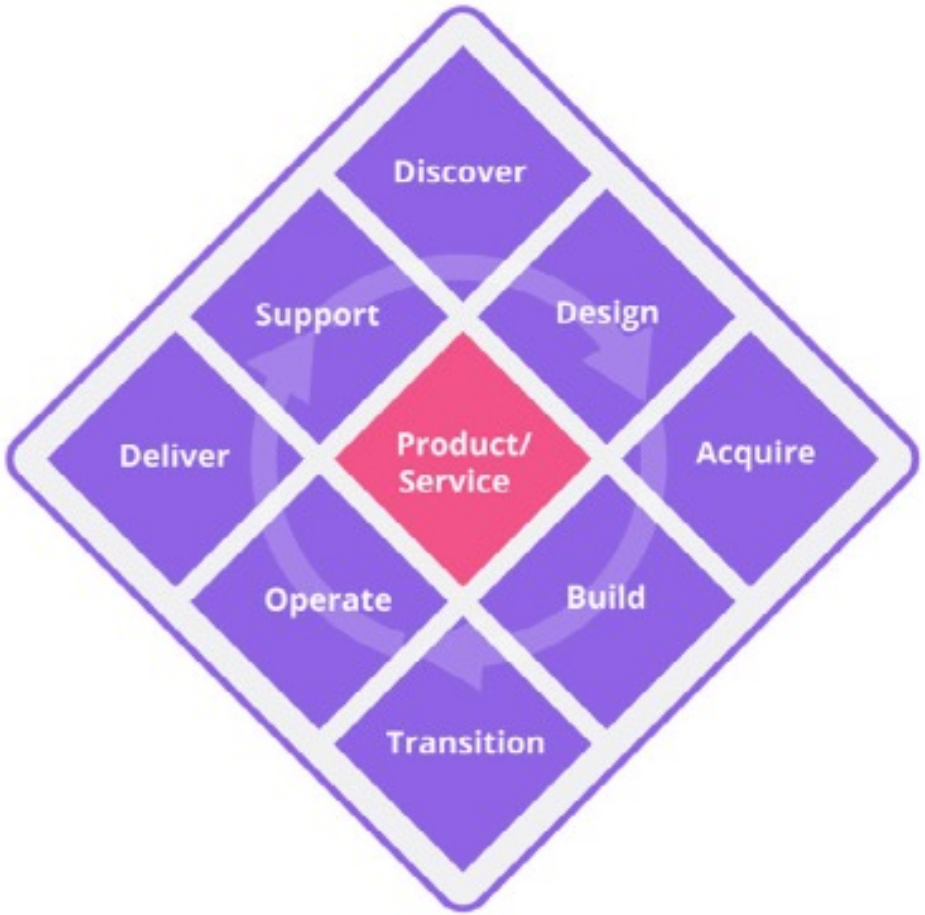


Figure 1.6 The ITIL Product and Service Lifecycle Model

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Lifecycle management activities

To manage digital products and services throughout their shared lifecycle, **organizations** perform **lifecycle management activities**.

These activities enable and support the lifecycle but are not performed in a fixed sequence; they combine in context to form value streams.

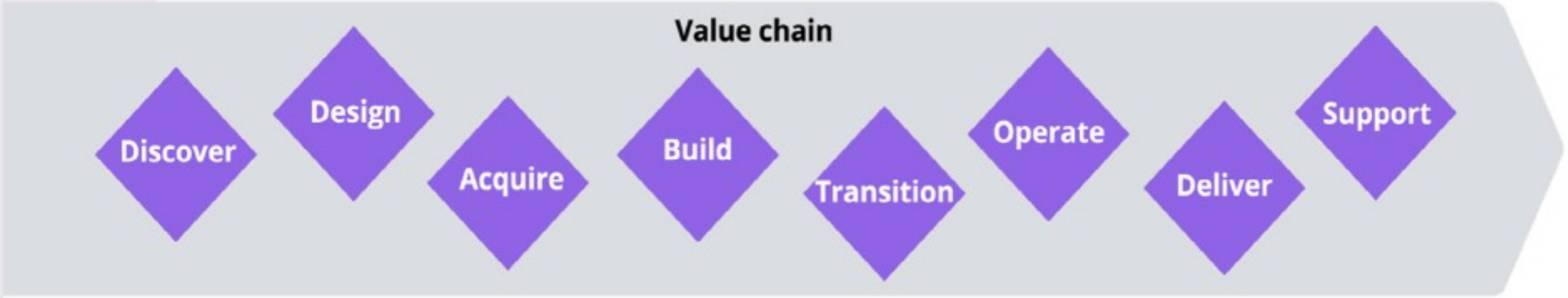


Figure 4.2 Product and service management activities: a chain of stepping stones

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Operating models and value chains

An organization's purpose defines its intent, but it is the operating model, value chain, and practices that bring that intent to life.

Organization's purpose

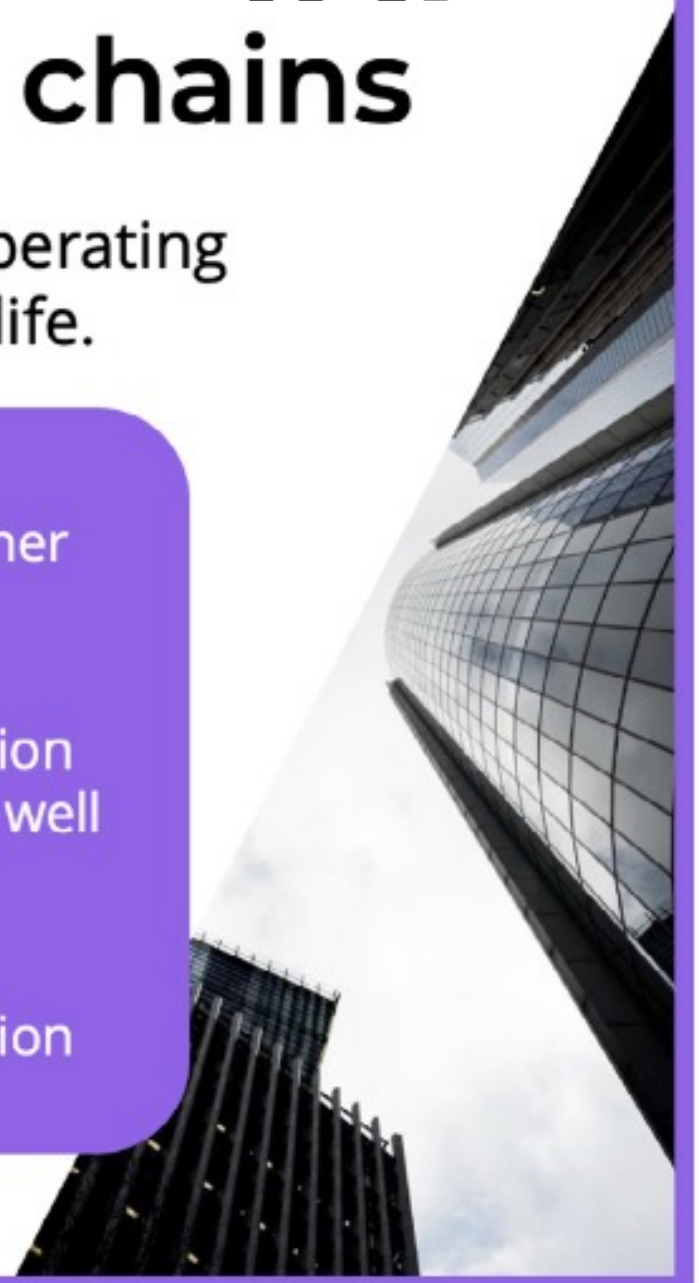
Describes what an organization does for its consumers and other stakeholders and why.

Operating model

A conceptual and/or visual representation of how an organization co-creates value with its customers and other stakeholders, as well as how the organization runs itself.

Value chain

An entire set of activities that enables value through the provision of a product or service.



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Operating model canvas

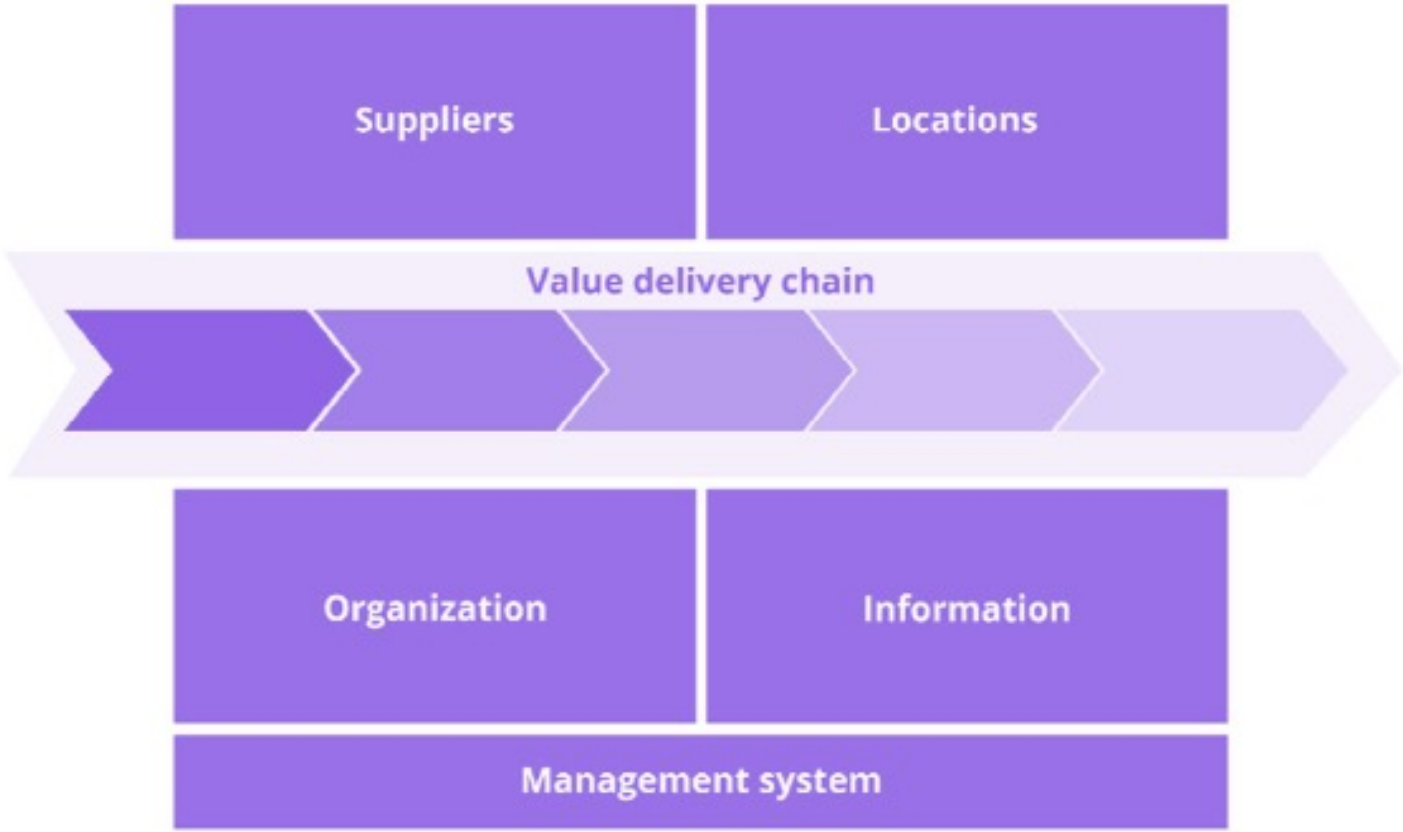
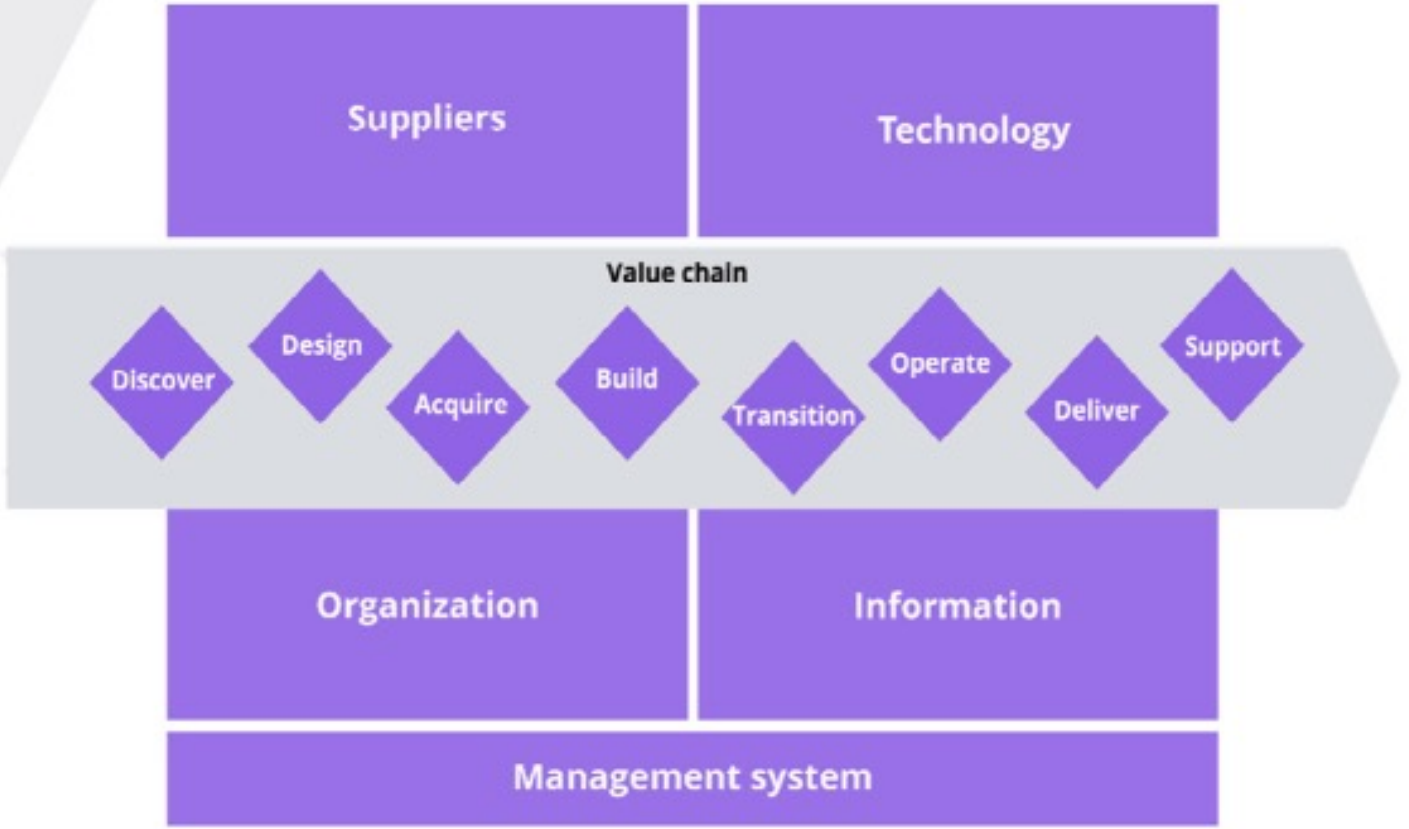


Figure 2.3 Operating Model Canvas (*ITIL Strategy* Official Book)

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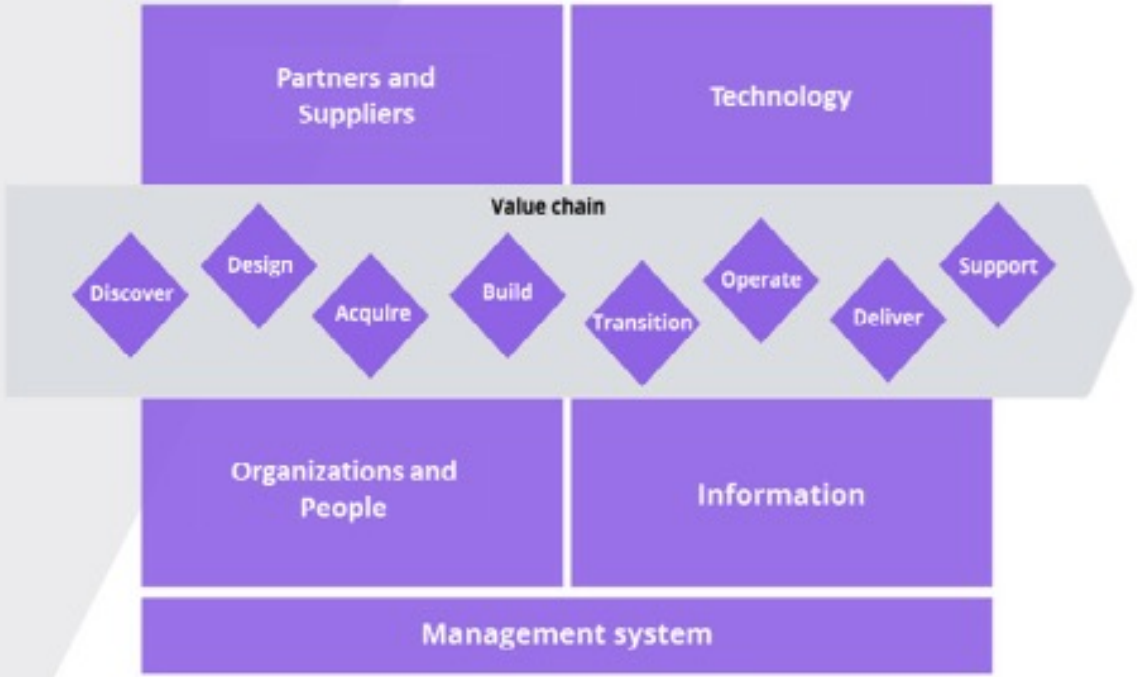
Operating model canvas and ITIL



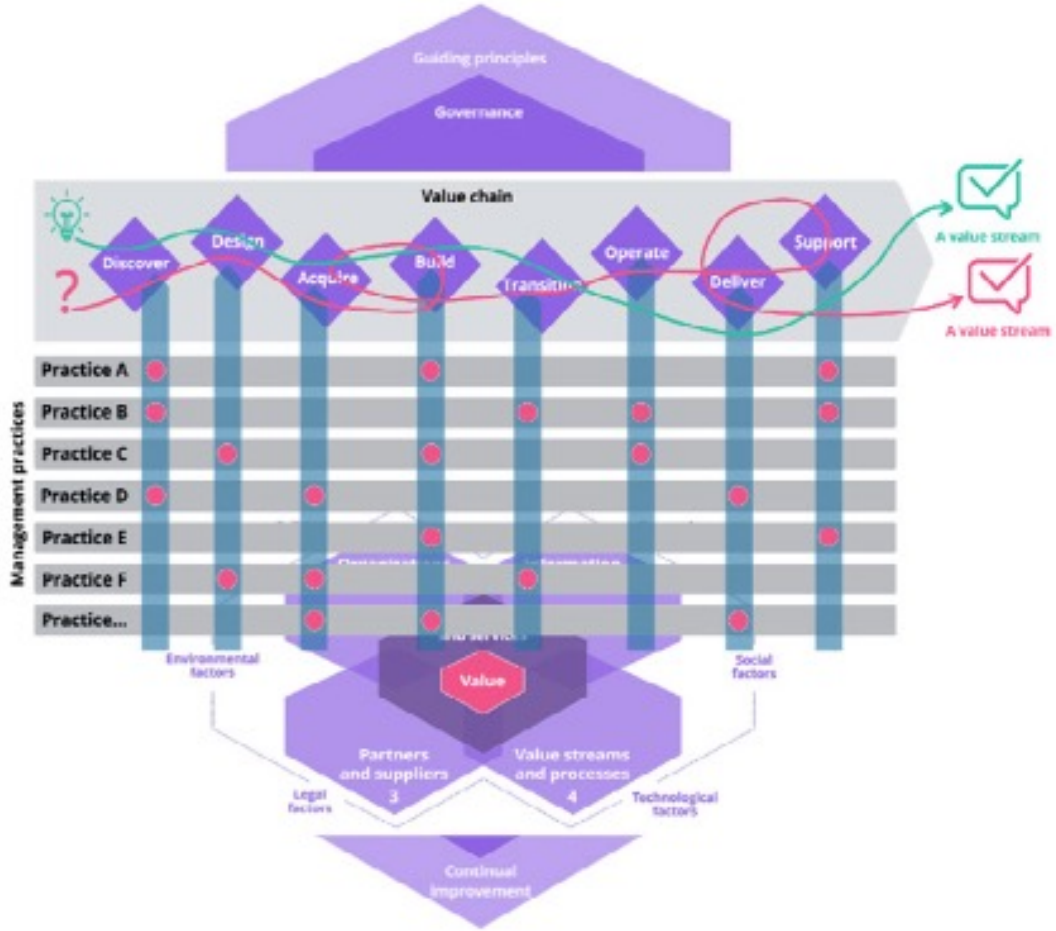
Adapted from Figure 2.3 Operating Model Canvas
(*ITIL Strategy* Official Book)

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Operating model canvas and ITIL Value System



Adapted from Figure 2.3 Operating Model Canvas (*ITIL Strategy* Official Book)



Adapted from Figure 1.10 The key models of ITIL (Version 5): the big picture (*ITIL Foundation* Official Book)

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Purpose, operating model, and value chain

- Each **value chain activity** is supported and enabled by several **management practices**.
- Each practice contributes to managing a specific aspect of digital products and services.

Together, these practices enable organizations to manage digital products and services effectively **throughout their lifecycle**.

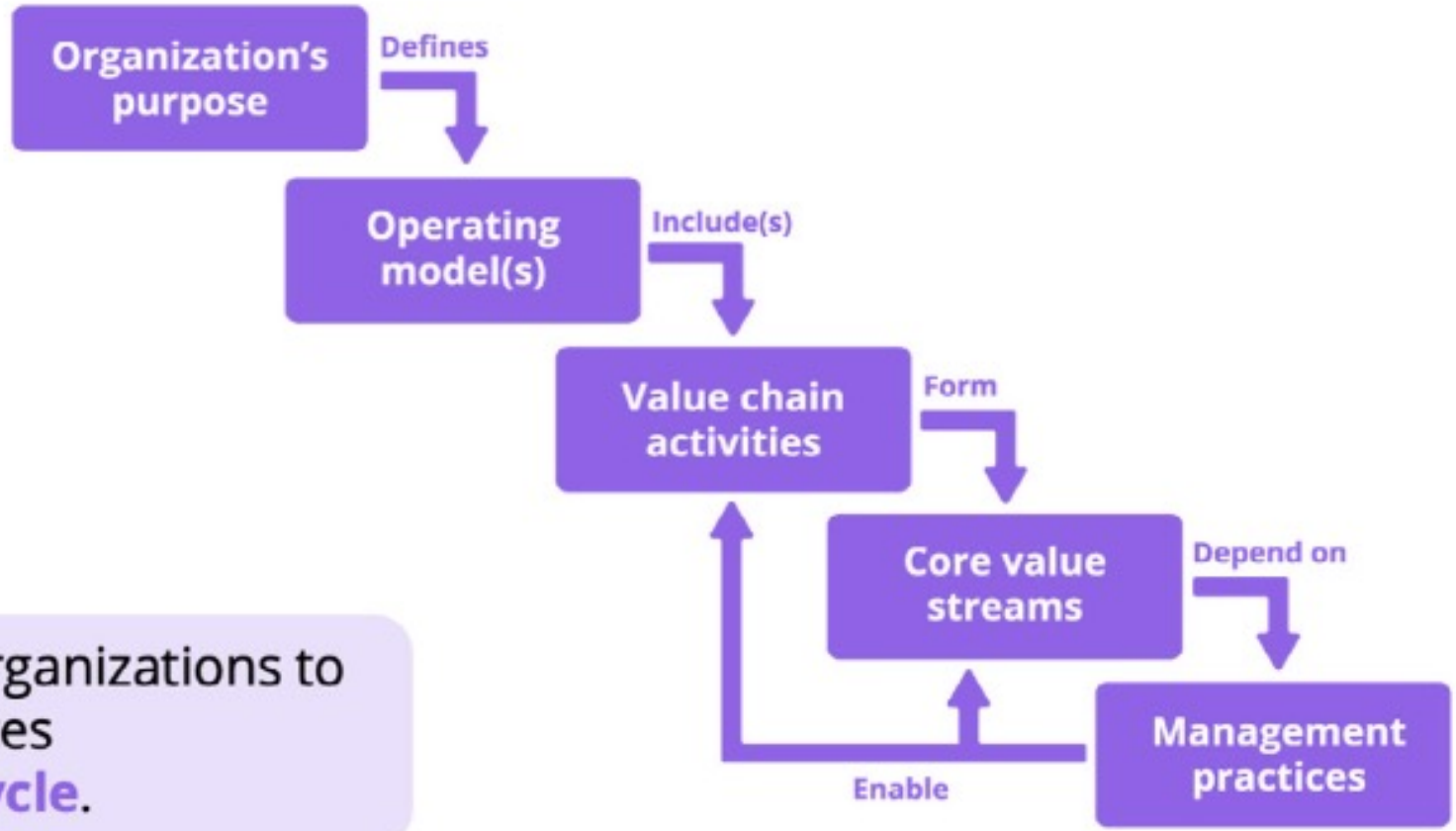


Figure 5.3 From organization's purpose to value streams

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Value chain patterns

Table 5.2 Summary of the value chain patterns

Organization's purpose	Operating model	Who is typically responsible for other product and service management activities?	Typical reasons to adopt the value chain pattern
1. **To support the core business of the company with effective and efficient technology solutions.**	All activities of the ITIL Product and Service Lifecycle management from 'discover' to 'support'.	N/A	Use of internally developed digital products to perform core business activities and achieve competitive advantage.
2. **To ensure efficient and reliable delivery of IT services based on third-party technology solutions.**	Acquire, transition, operate, deliver, support.	Discover: business customers. Design, build: external vendors.	Use of standard digital products to enable and support business activities and ensure efficiency.
3. **To ensure efficient and reliable delivery of IT services and coordination of third parties responsible for product development and operation.**	Deliver, support.	Discover: business customers. Design, build: external vendors. Acquire, transition, operate: external managed service providers.	Use of standard digital products to enable and support business activities and maximize efficiency.
4. **To provide digital products to individual users and small businesses.**	All activities of the ITIL Product and Service Lifecycle management from 'discover' to 'support'.	N/A	Mass delivery of service based on internally developed digital products, as the main business of the organization.
5. **To develop and ship software to meet specific customer's requirement.**	Design, acquire, build, transition (partially).	Discover: customers. Transition: jointly with customers and/or third parties. Operate: customers or third parties. Deliver, support: customers.	Custom software development as a business.
6. **To implement, operate, and support consumer's digital platform and software solutions.**	Transition (partially). Operate, support.	Discover: customers. Design, acquire, build: software vendors or customers. Transition: jointly with customers and/or software vendors.	N/A

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Management practices

Practices provide the methods and resources that make value chain activities work.

Management practice

A set of organizational resources and capabilities designed and adopted for performing work or accomplishing an objective.

ITIL includes 34 management practices in two groups:

- Product and service management practices
- General management practices



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The 34 ITIL management practices

Product and service management practices (22)

Availability management

Business analysis

Capacity and performance management

Change enablement

Deployment management

Incident management

IT asset management

Problem management

Release management

Service design

General Management Practices (12)

Architecture management

Knowledge management

Measurement and reporting

Portfolio management

Organizational change management

Workforce and talent management

Supplier management

Continual improvement

Project management

Strategy management

Relationship management

Risk management

Monitoring and event management

Infrastructure and platform management

Service catalogue management

Service desk

Service financial management

Service configuration management

Information security management

Service level management

Service request management

Service validation and testing

Software development and management

Service continuity management

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Practices in the value chain

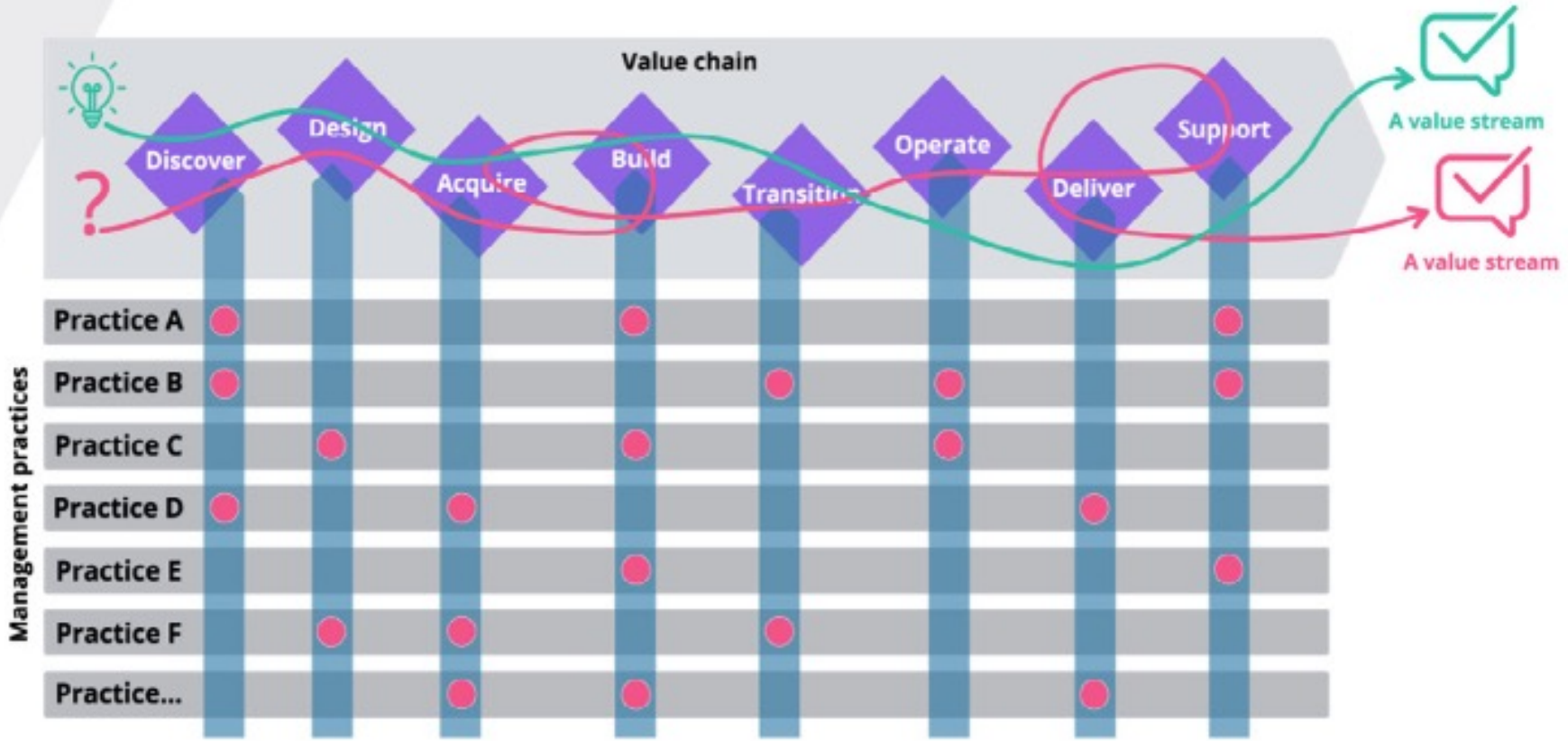


Figure 1.9 Management practices enable and support the value chain activities

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Practices in the value chain

Adapted from Table B.1 Enabling and supporting management practices of the product and service management activities

	Discover	Design	Acquire	Build	Transition	Operate	Deliver	Support
Monitoring and event management		E	S	E	E	E	E	E
Organizational change management		E		S	E			
Portfolio management	E	E						
Problem management		S				E	E	E
Project management		E	E	E	E			
Relationship management	E		S		S		E	E
Release management					E		E	E
Risk management	E	E	S	S	E	E	S	S
Service catalogue management		S			S		E	E
Service configuration management		S	E	S	E	S	S	S
Service continuity management		E	S	E	S	E	S	E
Service design		E						
Service desk							E	E

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Structure of ITIL Official Practice Guides

ITIL Official Books include 34 Official Practice Guides. Each guide follows the same structure and addresses the following aspects of the management practices:

Adapted from Table 5.4 Structure and contents of the ITIL Official Practice Guides

Practice guide chapters	Contents
General Information	Purpose, scope, key terms, success factors, key metrics
Value streams and processes	Processes, contribution to value stream
Organizations and people	Roles and competencies, organizational solution
Information and technology	Data, tools, automation, recommendations for automation
Partners and suppliers	Dependencies and support
Capability assessment and development	Maturity Model, capability criteria, self-assessment
Recommendations for the practice success	Recommendations, development, and application



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Benefits of ITIL Official Practice Guides

The consistent structure of the guides leads directly to several important benefits, which make them practical and effective tools for organizations.

Consistent
- common structure across all 34 practices.

Comprehensive
- covers people, process, tech, and suppliers.

Practical
- includes metrics, roles, and recommendations.

Continual improvement
- linked to the ITIL Maturity Model



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Discover: purpose and metrics of success

Purpose

The purpose is to ensure **continual alignment** of the product roadmaps and related service offerings with the **needs of service consumers** and with the **organizational strategy**.

Success metrics

- Strategic fit of the organization's products and service offerings.
- Market relevance of the products and service offerings.
- Stakeholder satisfaction with products and service offerings.
- Commercial success of the products (if applicable).

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Discover: overview

How the 'discover' activity works:

A continual process, not a one-off, long-interval-based activity

Performed at 3 levels

- Organizational level: vision, strategy, target consumers.
- Portfolio level: optimize portfolio, align with strategy.
- Product level: keep roadmaps and services aligned with consumer needs and strategy.

Influenced by

- PESTLE factors: Political, Economic, Social, Technological, Legal, and Environmental.
- Stakeholder input: customers, shareholders, governing bodies.



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Discover: workflow

The high-level workflow of each 'discover' iteration comprises four steps:

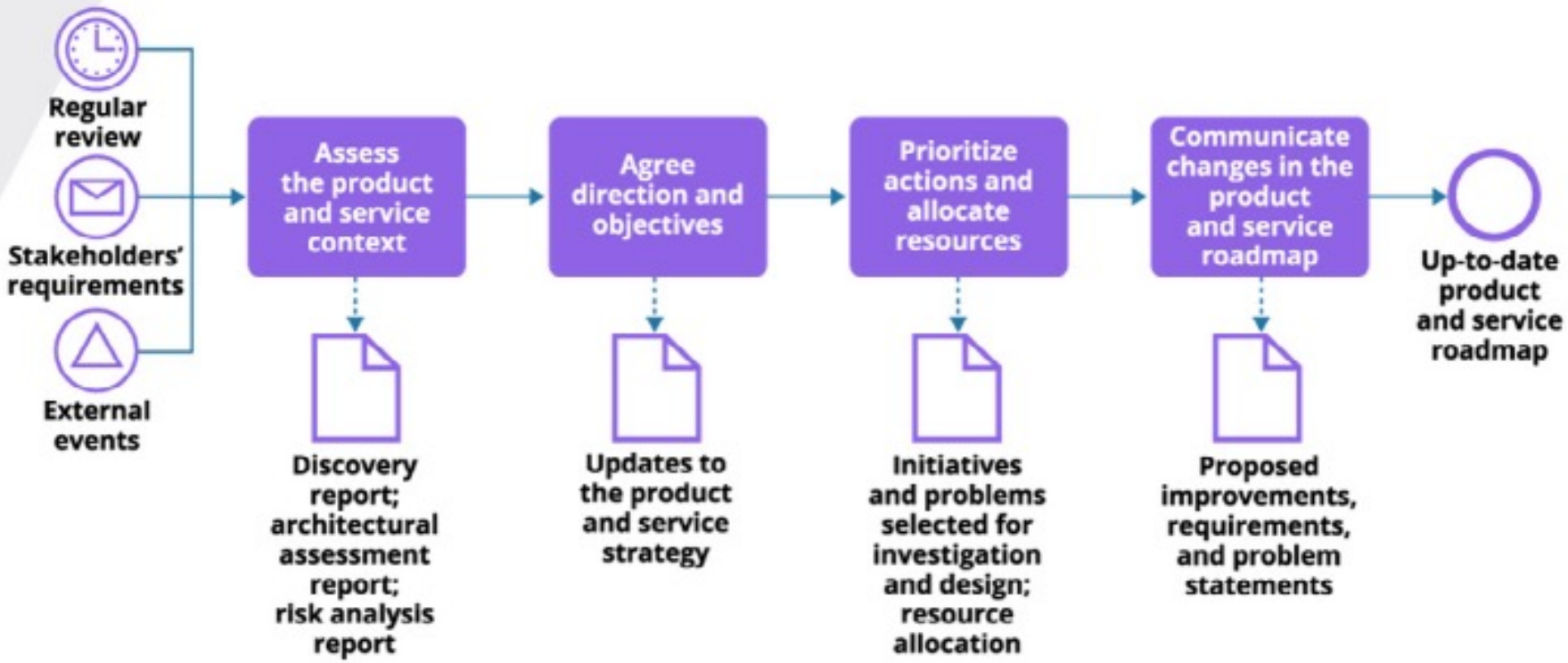


Figure 4.4 High-level workflow of the 'discover' activity

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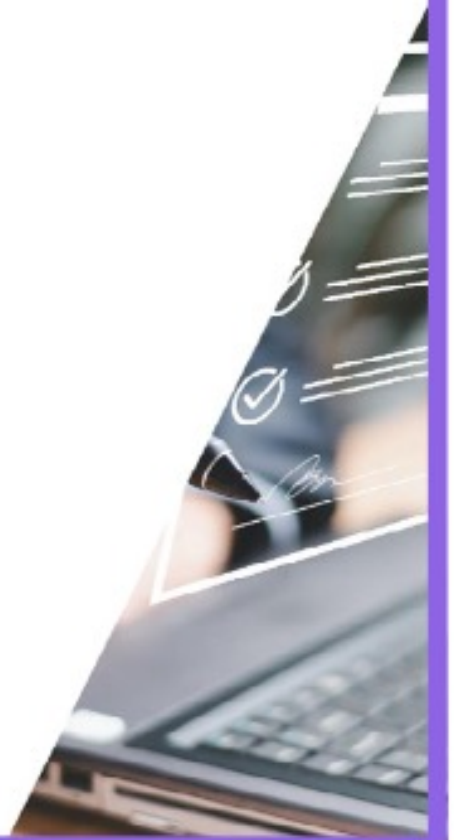
Discover: roles and outputs

Roles

- Product teams.
- Relationship managers.
- Business analysts.
- Service owners.

Outputs

- Updated product roadmap.



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Discover: management practices



Enabling practices
Architecture management
Business analysis
Continual improvement
Portfolio management
Relationship management
Risk management

Supporting practices
Knowledge management
Measurement and reporting
Service financial management
Strategy management
Supplier management
Workforce and talent management

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ITIL Car Rental | ‘Discover’



Anna: ...Marketing research shows growing interest in driverless cars among both our existing and potential customers...



Maria: ...Initial findings show interest but highlight concerns around safety, control, and accountability...



Max: ...our objective is to assess whether these platforms can support real-time data exchange, fleet-level automation, and multilingual AI-driven support.



Anna: Our objective is a safe, reliable, eco-conscious, and fully supported driverless rental experience.

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Design: purpose and metrics of success

Purpose

The purpose is to create **prototypes and specifications** for products and services, detailing their functionality, user experience, and operational framework.

Success metrics

- Quality of the product specifications and prototypes.
- Design cycle time.
- Adherence to the product roadmap and other relevant guidelines.
- Stakeholder satisfaction with the 'design' activities.

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Design: overview

Design is a dynamic activity that involves:

- creating new ideas
- adapting to changes
- generating solutions.

Digital product and service design uses technology and organizational resources to create **prototypes** and **specifications**.

Depending on the agreed positioning, strategy, and portfolio, organizations may adopt different **approaches** to product and service design:

- **Proactive:** anticipate needs.
- **Reactive:** respond to requirements.



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Design: key definitions

The design activity produces **two key outputs** that guide development and ensure alignment: product specifications and product prototypes.

Product/service specification
A detailed document that outlines critical aspects, requirements, and characteristics of a product to be built. It typically includes descriptions of the product's features, functionalities, technical requirements, performance criteria, and user interface details.

Product/service prototype
An initial version of a product that demonstrates its basic form, functionality, and operational capabilities. It is used to test and refine the product's design and functionality and test hypotheses. Prototypes vary in complexity and purpose, ranging from visual mockups to fully functional models.



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Design: Human-centred design

A user-focused approach to design

What is Human-Centred Design (HCD)?

- A problem-solving approach prioritizing users' needs and experiences.
- Rooted in empathy and iterative process.
- Strong focus on user.

HCD is guided by principles:

- Focus on users and their tasks.
- User involvement throughout design.
- Iterative design and evaluation.
- Full user experience considered.
- Multidisciplinary skills and perspectives.

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Design: workflow

The high-level workflow of each 'design' activity comprises four steps:

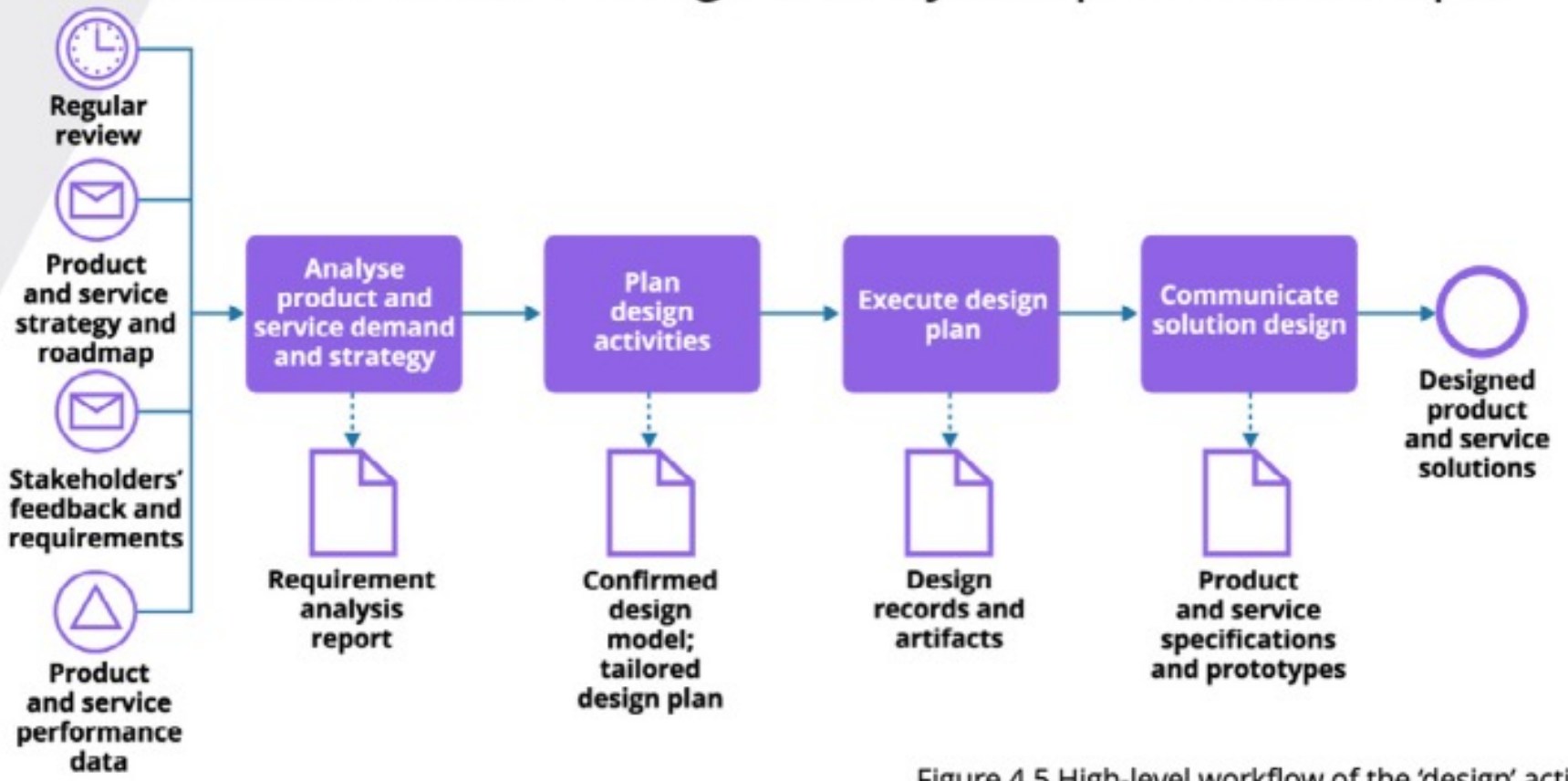


Figure 4.5 High-level workflow of the 'design' activity

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Design: roles and outputs

Roles

- Product teams.
- In some cases, specialized design teams.

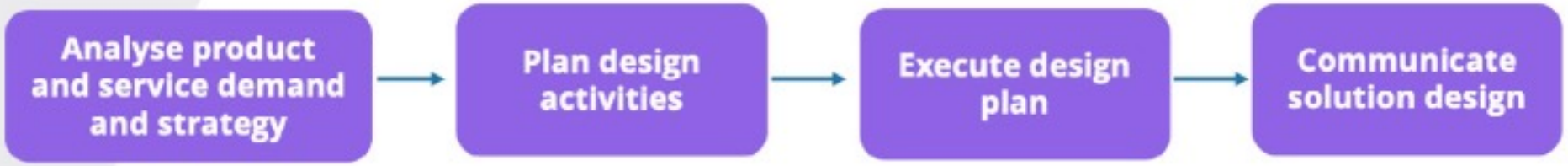
Outputs

- Product and service specifications and prototypes.



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Design: management practices



Enabling practices	
Architecture management	Organizational change management
Availability management	Portfolio management
Business analysis	Project management
Capacity and performance management	Risk management
Continual improvement	Service continuity management
Information security management	Service design
Infrastructure and platform management	Service financial management
Measurement and reporting	Software development and management
Monitoring and event management	

Supporting practices
IT asset management
Knowledge management
Problem management
Service catalogue management
Service configuration management
Service level management
Supplier management

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Acquire: purpose and metrics of success

Purpose

The purpose is to **secure** and **allocate** necessary **resources** efficiently, ensuring the sustainability and scalability of products and services.

Success metrics

- Quality of resources and services.
- Acquire cycle time.
- Adherence to the product roadmap and other relevant guidelines.
- Stakeholder satisfaction with the 'acquire' activities, timelines, and acquired resources.

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Acquire: overview

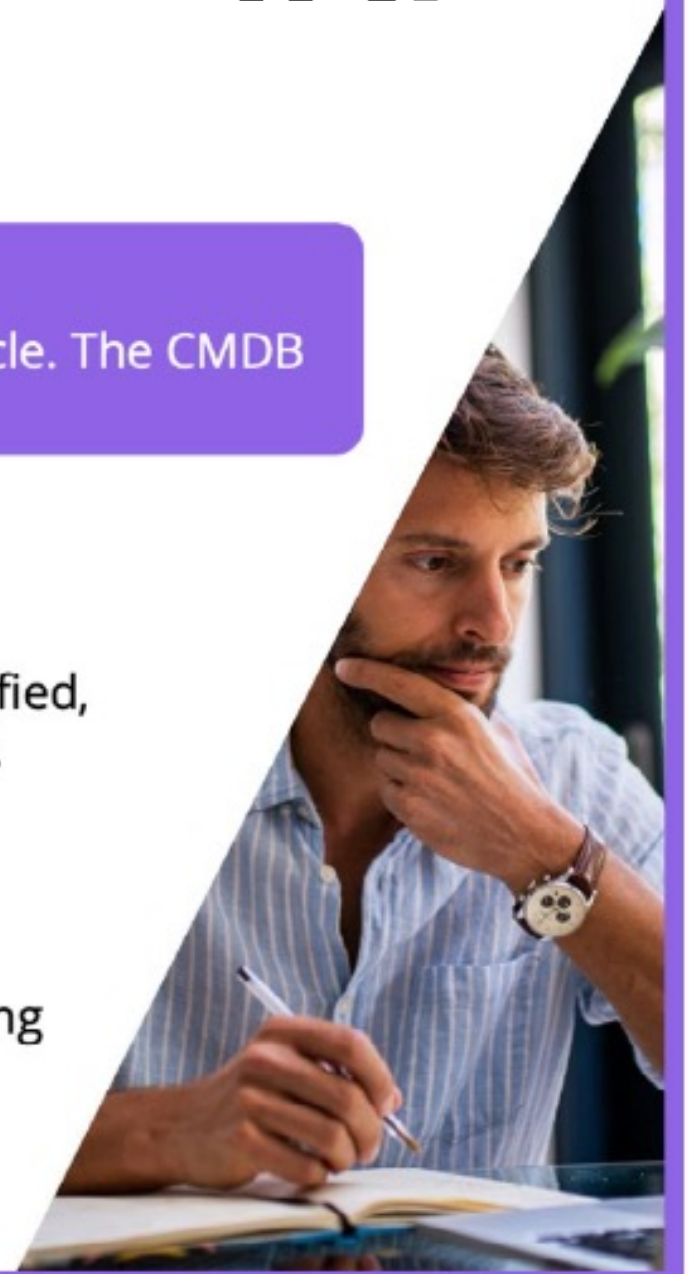
Configuration Management Database (CMDB)

A database used to store configuration records throughout their lifecycle. The CMDB also maintains the relationships between configuration records.

Acquire ensures resources are available for products and services.

How the 'acquire' activity works:

- **Digital products** combine internal and external resources which are identified, recorded, and tracked in the Configuration Management Database (CMDB).
- **Resources** are needed for operations, delivery, and support.
- Acquire includes **sourcing** externally or reallocating internally.
- May be triggered by new product, operations, or supplier review cycles, using CMDB data to inform decisions.



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Acquire: workflow

The high-level workflow of the 'acquire' activity comprises five steps:

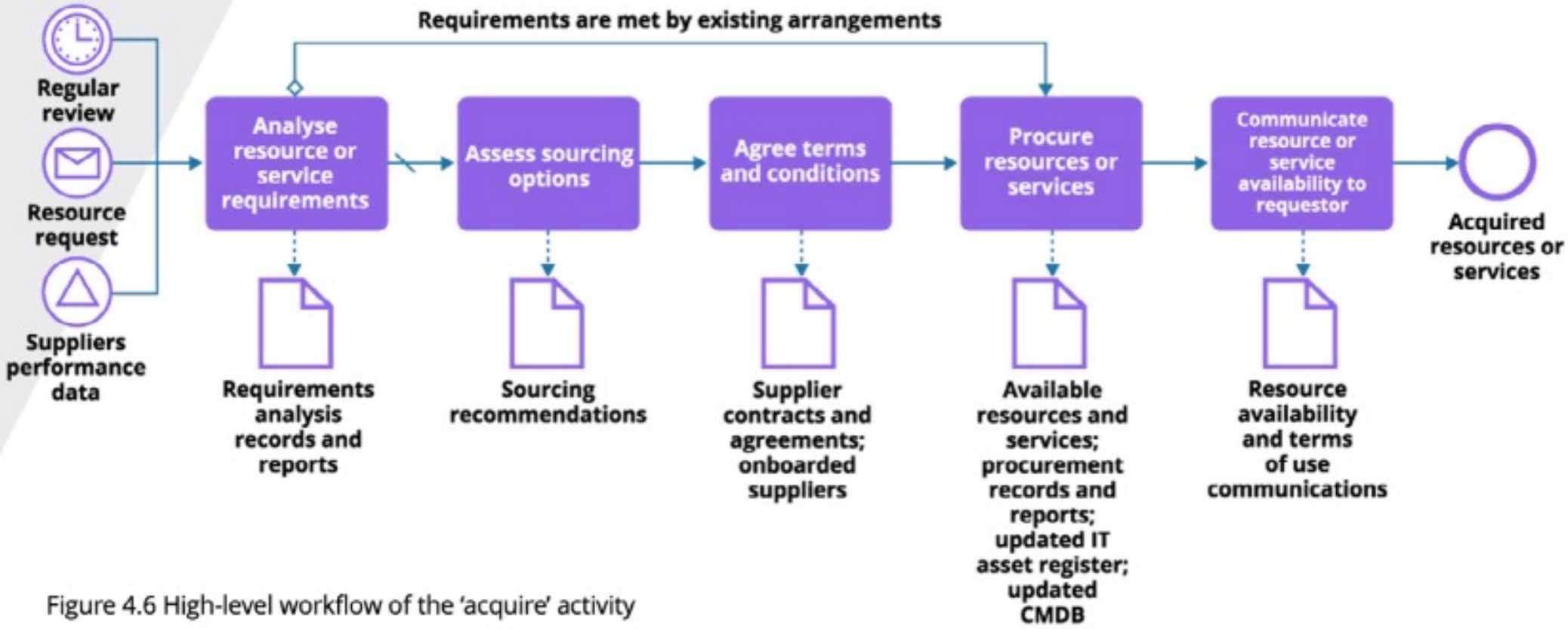


Figure 4.6 High-level workflow of the 'acquire' activity

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Acquire: roles and outputs

Roles

- Specialized procurement teams in collaboration with product teams.
- Project teams.
- Other stakeholders.

Outputs

- Acquired resources and services.



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Acquire: management practices



Enabling practices
Architecture management
Continual improvement
IT asset management
Project management
Service configuration management
Service financial management
Supplier management
Workforce and talent management

Supporting practices	
Availability management	Monitoring and event management
Capacity and performance management	Relationship management
Information security management	Risk management
Infrastructure and platform management	Service continuity management
Knowledge management	Service level management
Measurement and reporting	Software development and management

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Build: purpose and metrics of success

Purpose

The purpose is to **develop**, **integrate**, and **test** digital products, transforming designs into **functional solutions**.

Success metrics

- Quality of the product solutions.
- Building cycle.
- Adherence to the product roadmap and other relevant guidelines.
- Stakeholder satisfaction with the product solutions.

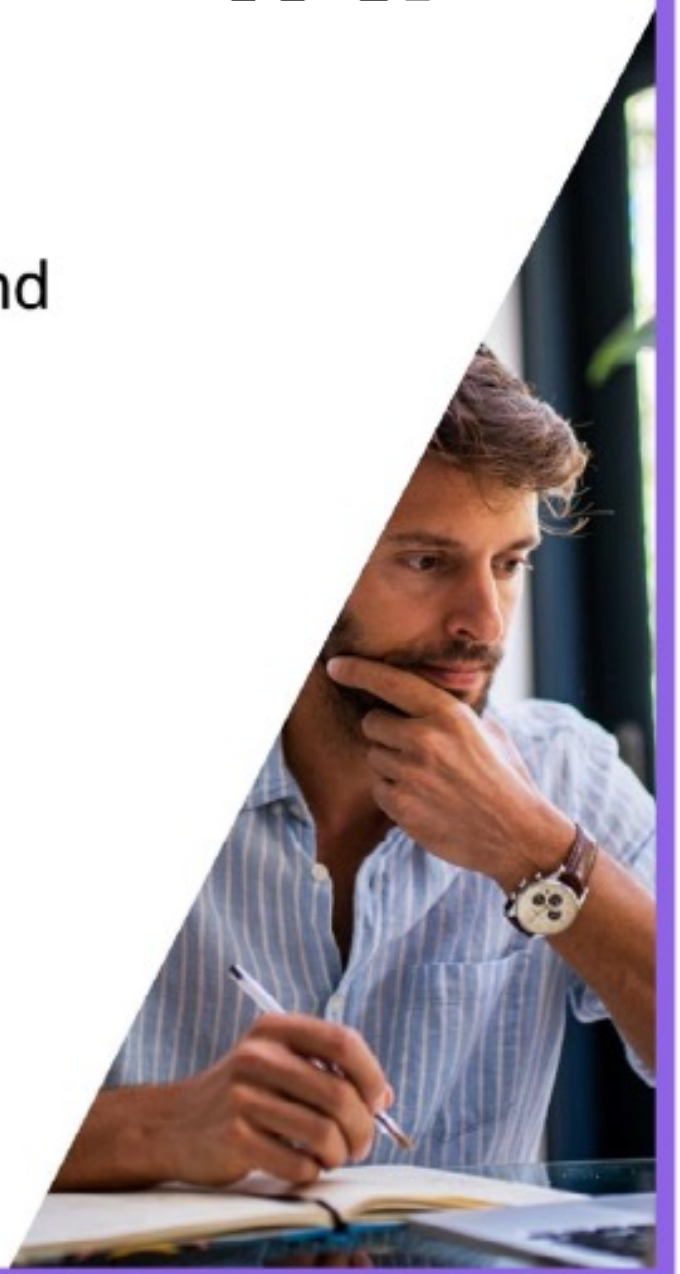
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Build: overview

Build transforms solution designs into working products and services.

How the 'build' activity works:

- Activities: software development, system integration, configuration, process development.
- Includes documentation, validation, and testing.
- Can be automated through continuous integration.



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Build: key definitions

Testing
Activity in which a system or component is executed under specified conditions, the results are observed or recorded, and an evaluation is made of some aspect of the system or component.

Continuous integration
A software engineering method where developers regularly merge their code changes into a central repository, after which automated builds and tests are run. This process helps ensure that the codebase remains stable and functional by catching integration errors early and often.



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Build: workflow

The high-level workflow of each 'build' activity comprises four steps:

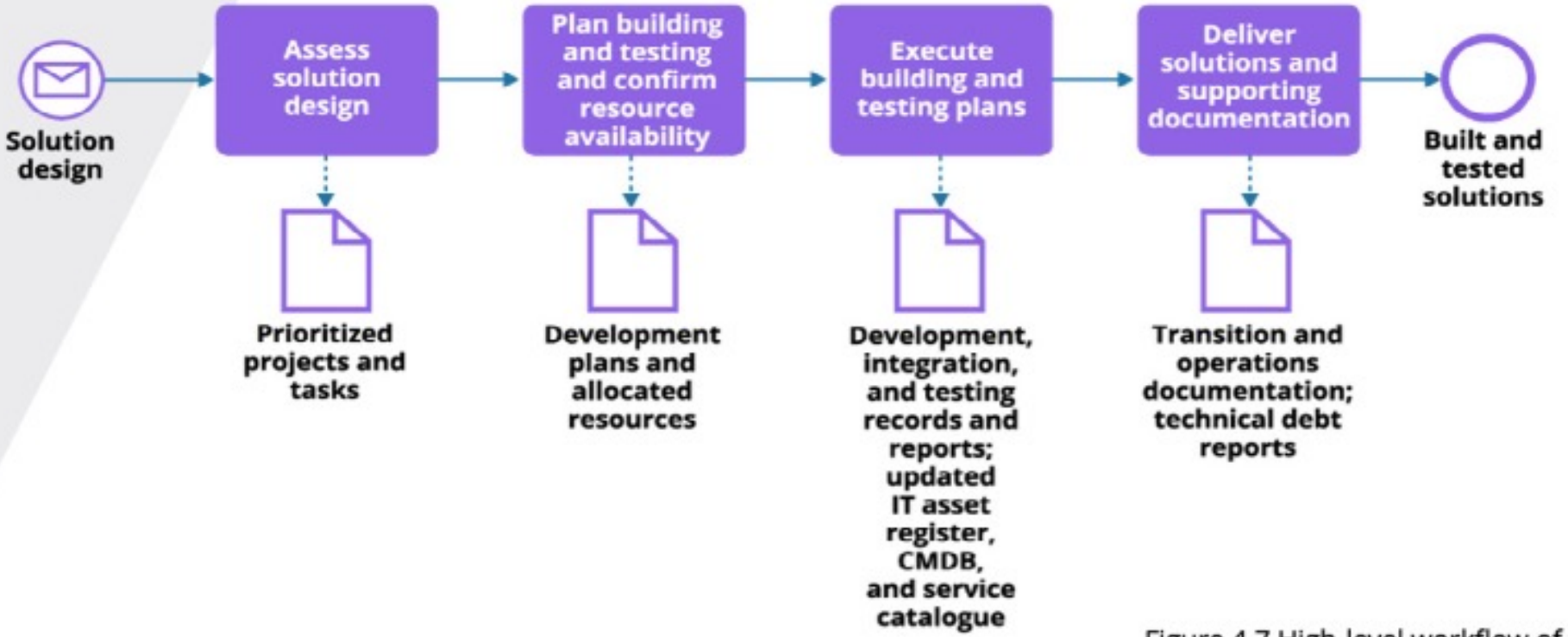


Figure 4.7 High-level workflow of the 'build' activity

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Build: roles and outputs

Roles

- Product teams or specialized software development teams.
- Infrastructure engineers.
- Testing teams.
- Project teams formed of the above.

Outputs

- Built and tested product solutions.



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Build: management practices



Enabling practices	
Architecture management	Monitoring and event management
Availability management	Project management
Capacity and performance management	Service continuity management
Continual improvement	Service validation and testing
Deployment management	Software development and management
Information security management	Supplier management
Infrastructure and platform management	Workforce and talent management
Measurement and reporting	

Supporting practices
IT asset management
Knowledge management
Organizational change management
Risk management
Service configuration management
Service financial management

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Transition: purpose and metrics of success

Purpose

The purpose is to seamlessly **introduce new** or **updated** products into operational environments and to ensure effective **onboarding/offboarding** of suppliers.

Success metrics

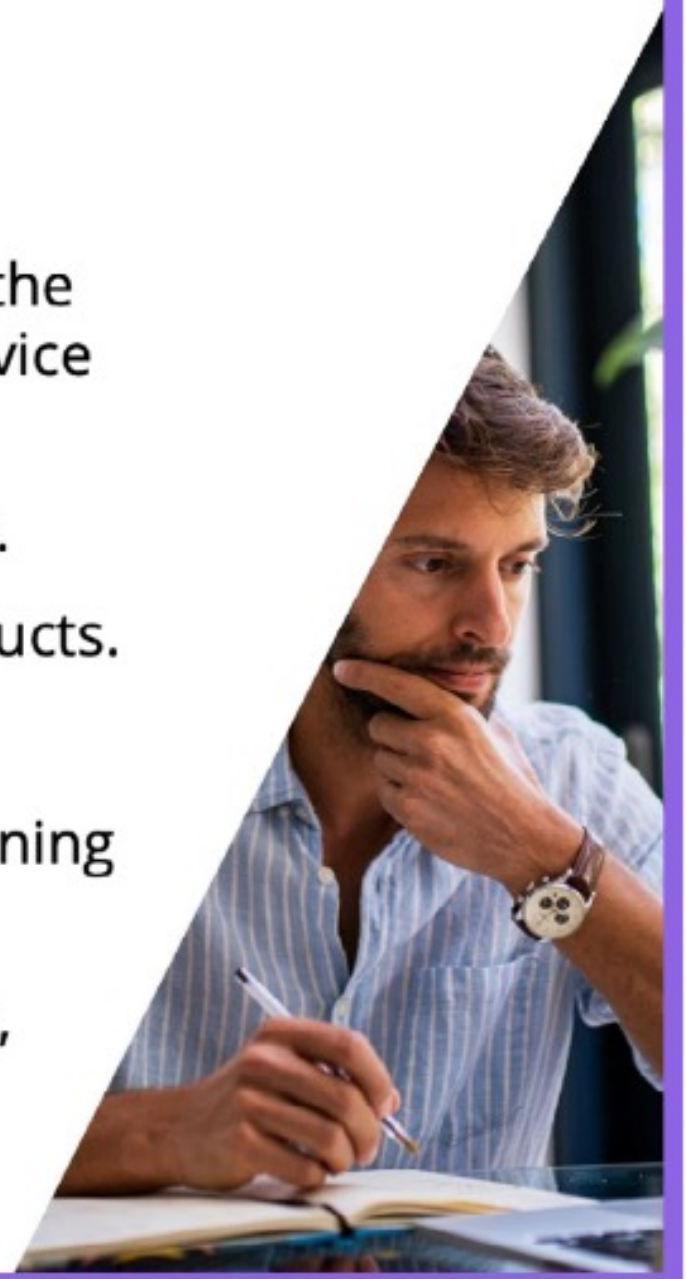
- Transition cycle (timeliness and duration).
- Negative impact of transition on service availability and performance.
- Number and impact of transition errors.
- Adherence to the product roadmap and other relevant guidelines.
- Stakeholder satisfaction with the transition process and results.

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Transition: overview

Transition moves built or acquired products and resources into the live environment, ensuring they are ready for operation and service delivery.

- Safely moves built products/resources into live environments.
- May require planned interruptions, especially for legacy products.
- Modern digital products allow smooth, low-impact updates.
- Includes onboarding/offboarding suppliers and decommissioning resources/products.
- Ensures readiness for operations through monitoring, testing, continuity, and security controls.



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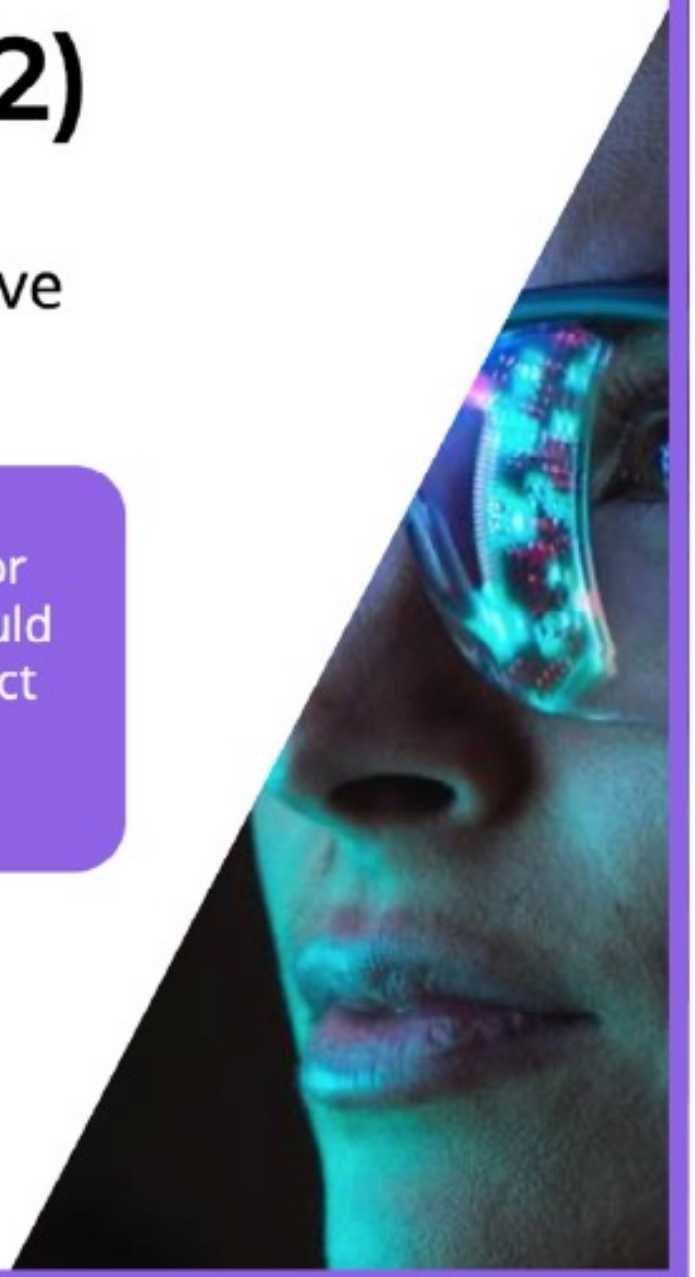
Transition: key definitions (1/2)

Transition relies on key terms that define how updates move into the live environment.

Release
A version of a product, service, or other configuration item, or a collection of configuration items, that is made available for use.

Change
The addition, modification, or removal of anything that could have a direct or indirect effect on products and services.

Release and **change** show how updates are packaged and authorized before production.



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Transition: key definitions (2/2)

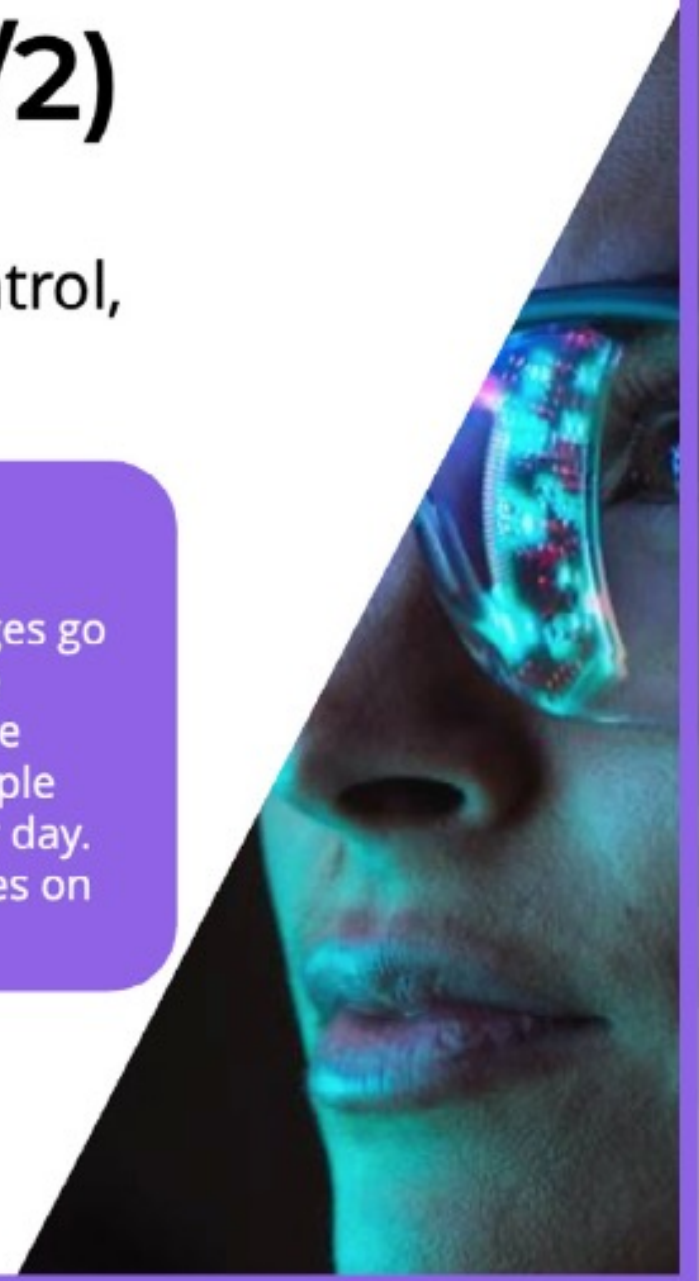
These terms show how transition balances speed with control, ensuring updates move safely into the live environment.

Continuous delivery

An approach to software development in which software can be released to production at any time. Frequent deployments are possible, but deployment decisions are taken case by case, usually because organizations prefer a slower rate of deployment.

Continuous deployment

An approach to software development in which changes go through the pipeline and are automatically put into the live environment, enabling multiple production deployments per day. Continuous deployment relies on continuous delivery.



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Transition: workflow

The high-level workflow of each 'transition' activity comprises four steps:

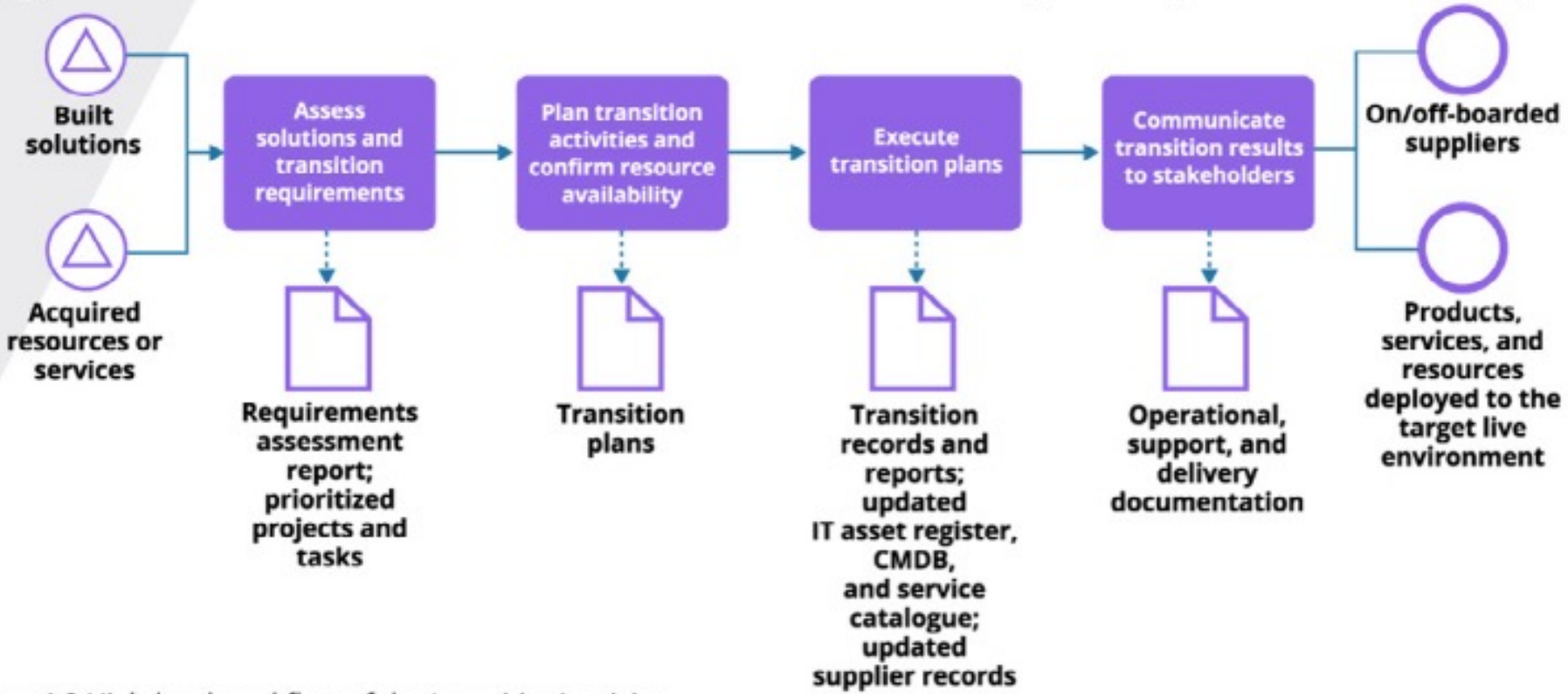


Figure 4.8 High-level workflow of the 'transition' activity

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Transition: roles and outputs

Roles

- Product teams.
- Specialized software development, infrastructure engineering, operations, support, and other relevant teams.
- Project teams formed of the above.

Outputs

- Products, services, and resources deployed to the target live environment and ready for operation.
- Onboarded/offboarded suppliers.



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Transition: management practices



Enabling practices	
Change enablement	Organizational change management
Continual improvement	Project management
Deployment management	Release management
Infrastructure and platform management	Risk management
IT asset management	Service catalogue management
Measurement and reporting	Service configuration management
Monitoring and event management	Service validation and testing

Supporting practices	
Availability management	Service financial management
Capacity and performance management	Service level management
Information security management	Software development and management
Knowledge management	Supplier management
Relationship management	Workforce and talent management
Service continuity management	

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ITIL Car Rental |'Transition'



Anna: We are ready to start field testing of our services. Autonomous cars have been received and set up. The updated app is available for testing. This phase must go smoothly to avoid any negative impact on our customers.



Max: After successful field testing, the new app has been made available to a group of customers participating in our BETA testing programme.



Omar: We are running training workshops for our support agents to ensure that autonomous car users receive the best customer support they expect. The product team monitors all support requests coming from pilot users to identify and implement service improvements.



Anna: We are working closely with our marketing department to create awareness of the new service.

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Operate: purpose and metrics of success

Purpose

The purpose is to **maintain** and **monitor** digital products and supporting systems, ensuring optimal performance and reliability.

Success metrics

- Coverage and effectiveness of monitoring and analysis.
- Live products' reliability, performance, and information security.
- Number and impact of incidents and performance deviations.
- Adherence to the product roadmap and other relevant guidelines.
- Stakeholder satisfaction with the product and service operation.

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Operate: overview

After transition, the focus shifts to operating products and systems, keeping them stable, reliable, and compliant.

How the 'operate' activity works:

- Runs platforms/systems to ensure performance and availability.
- Performs routine tests, backups, monitoring, event processing.
- Ensures that products and components operate as designed and in line with the organization's commitments to stakeholders.
- Ensures compliance with policies (continuity, security, certificates, licenses).
- Involves activities mostly invisible to customers unless issues arise.
- Proper operations prevent disruptions and ensure reliability.



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Operate: practices for reliability

To strengthen reliability, operations use practices like Site Reliability Engineering (SRE) and observability, which help systems perform consistently and remain scalable.

Reliability
The ability of a product, service, or other configuration item to perform its intended functi for a specified period of time or number of cycles.

Site Reliability Engineering (SRE)
A discipline that incorporates aspects of software engineering and applies them to infrastructure and operations problems. The main goal is to create scalable and highly reliable software systems.

Observability
The ability to understand the internal state of a complicated system by analysing its external outputs, such as metrics, logs, and traces.

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Operate: workflow

The high-level workflow of each 'operate' activity comprises three steps:

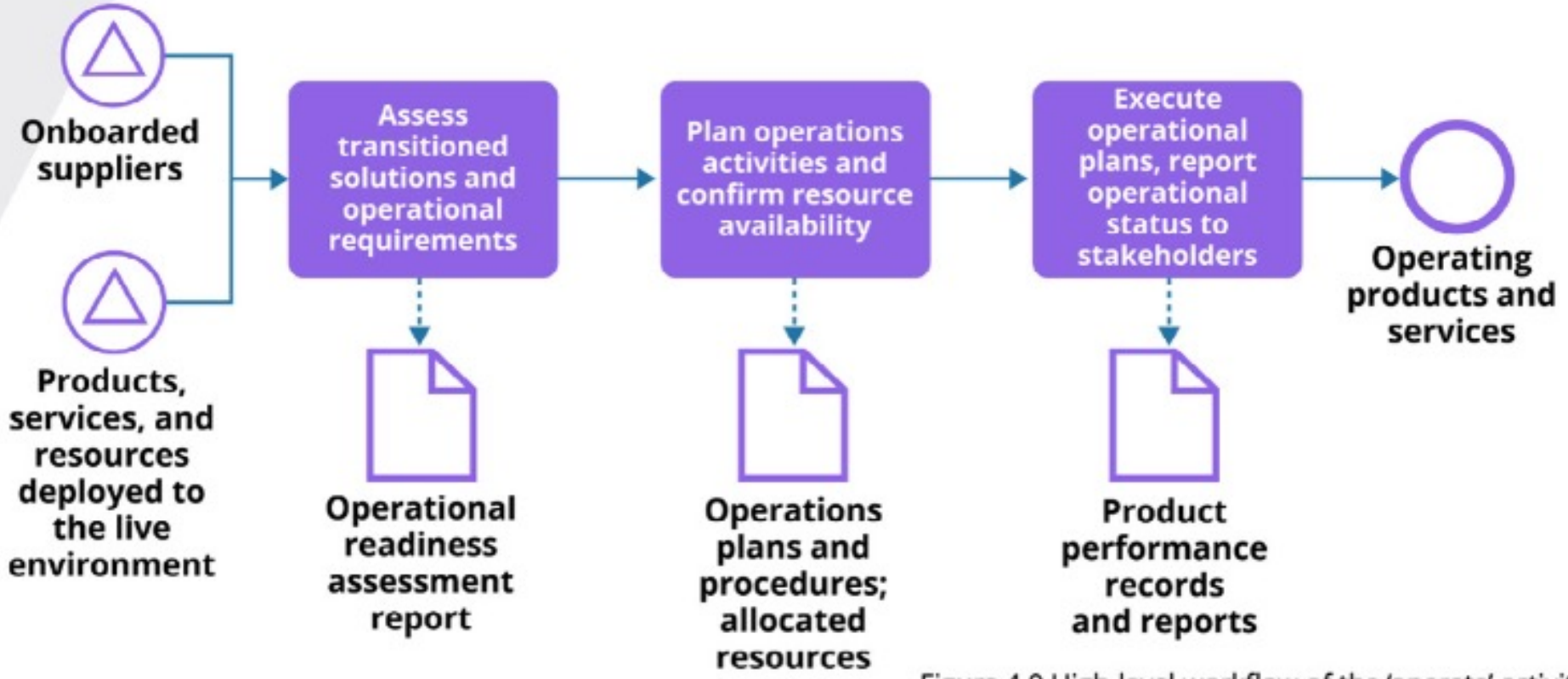


Figure 4.9 High-level workflow of the 'operate' activity

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Operate: key definitions

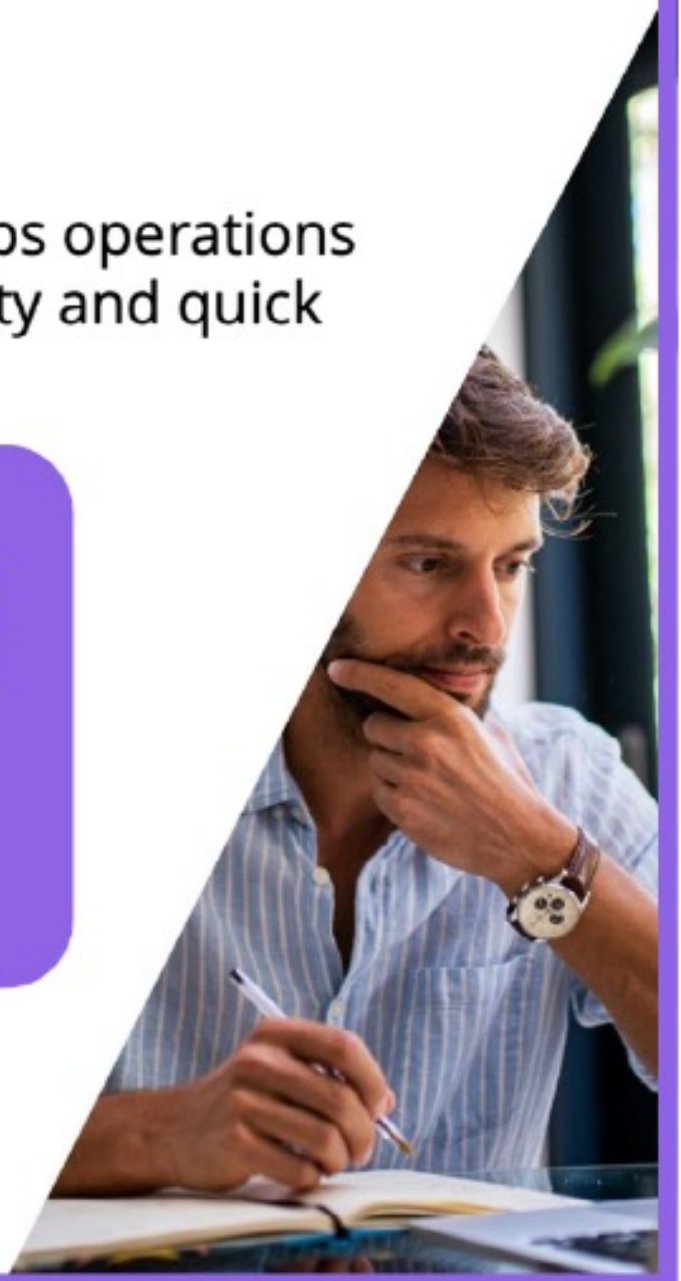
Understanding the difference between events and incidents helps operations teams know when to monitor and when to act, ensuring reliability and quick service restoration.

Event

Any change of state that has significance for the management of a service or other configuration item.

Incident

An unplanned interruption to a service or reduction in the quality of a service.



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Operate: roles and outputs

Roles

- Product teams.
- IT operations teams.
- SRE teams.

Outputs

- Operating products and services.
- Product performance records and reports.

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Operate: management practices

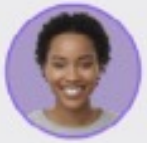
Assess transitioned solutions and operational requirements → **Plan operations activities and confirm resource availability** → **Execute operational plans, report operational status to stakeholders**

Enabling practices	
Availability management	Monitoring and event management
Capacity and performance management	Problem management
Change enablement	Risk management
Continual improvement	Service continuity management
Information security management	Software development and management
Infrastructure and platform management	Supplier management
Measurement and reporting	Workforce and talent management

Supporting practices
IT asset management
Knowledge management
Service configuration management
Service financial management
Service level management

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ITIL Car Rental | 'Operate'



Anna: All systems are up and running, and the new offering is ready to be delivered to customers in the cities where it is now available. You can now see it live in the updated apps.



Omar: Our AI Ops systems provide continuous monitoring of the new service, manage performance and capacity adjustments, and handle event management. We are ready for first customers.

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Deliver: purpose and metrics of success

Purpose

The purpose is to provide **services** to users, manage **user onboarding/offboarding**, maintain **service quality standards**, and gather consumers' **feedback**.

Success metrics

- Customer and user satisfaction with service quality.
- Service performance against the agreed SLA targets.
- Adherence to the product and service strategy and other relevant guidelines.
- Stakeholder satisfaction with service delivery.

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Deliver: overview

The ‘deliver’ activity focuses on delivering services to users in line with Service Level Agreements (SLAs). It involves fulfilment of users’ service requests, user onboarding, and other service actions

How the ‘deliver’ activity works:

- Provides access to product resources.
- Transfers goods as part of the service.
- Performs service actions with or for users.
- Directly linked to SLAs and quality criteria.
- Exact scope depends on product architecture and design and service agreements.



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Deliver: key definitions

SLAs define the standards for delivery, and service requests are how users trigger those services.

Service request
A request from a user or a user's authorized representative that initiates a service action which has been agreed as a normal part of service delivery.

Service Level Agreement (SLA)
A documented agreement between a service provider and a customer that identifies both the services required and the agreed level of service.



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Deliver: workflow

The high-level workflow of each 'deliver' activity comprises three steps:

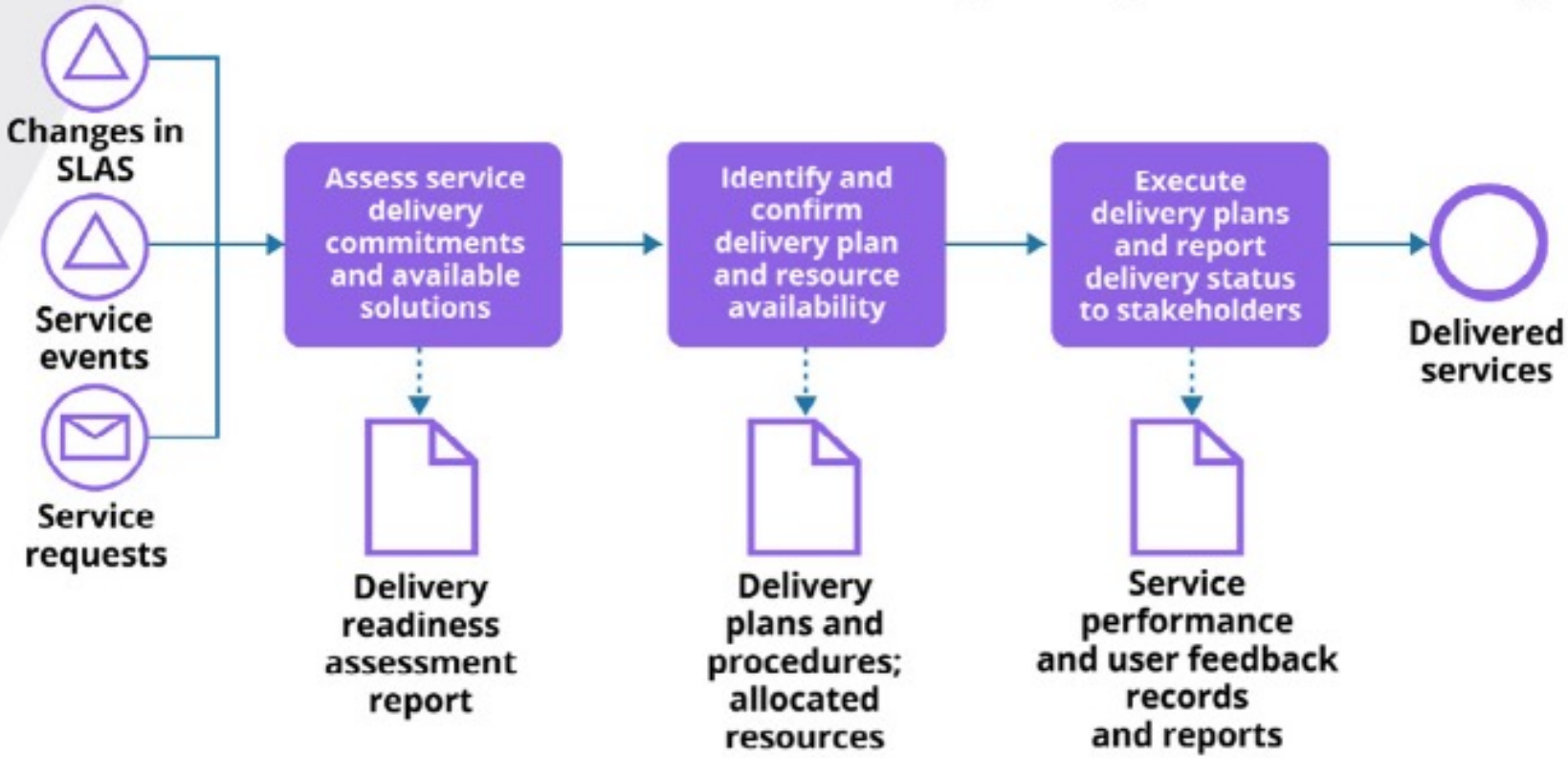


Figure 4.10 High-level workflow of the 'deliver' activity

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Deliver: roles and outputs

Roles

- Product teams.
- Service delivery teams.
- User support teams.
- Service desk teams.

Outputs

- Delivered services.
- Service performance and user feedback records and reports.

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Deliver: management practices

Assess service delivery commitments and available solutions → **Identify and confirm delivery plan and resource availability** → **Execute delivery plans and report delivery status to stakeholders**

Enabling practices	
Continual improvement	Release management
Incident management	Service catalogue management
Infrastructure and platform management	Service desk
Measurement and reporting	Service level management
Monitoring and event management	Service request management
Problem management	Software development and management
Relationship management	Supplier management

Supporting practices
Knowledge management
Risk management
Service configuration management
Service continuity management
Service financial management

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Support: purpose and metrics of success

Purpose

The purpose is to identify and resolve **incidents**, fulfil **disaster recovery procedures**, and capture **consumer's feedback**.

Success metrics

- Customer and user satisfaction with service support.
- Speed of normal service restoration.
- Negative impact of incidents and disasters on the organization and customers.
- Support performance against the agreed SLA targets and product performance objectives.
- Adherence to the product and service strategy and other relevant guidelines.

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Support: overview

Even with strong operations and delivery, incidents and failures still occur. This is where the 'support' activity plays a critical role.

How the 'support' activity works:

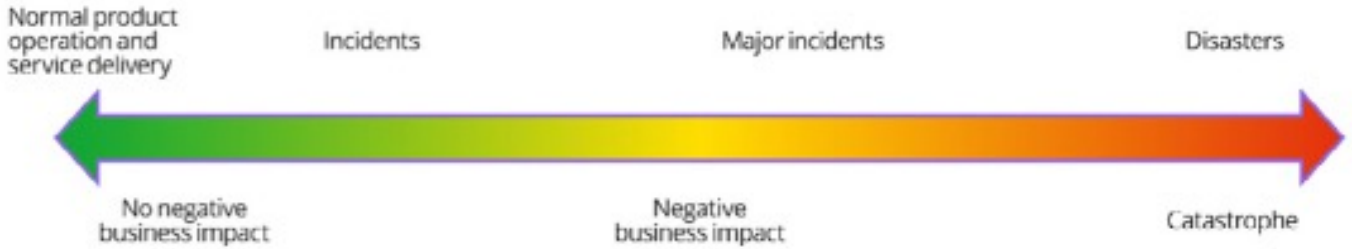
- Resolves incidents and disasters.
- Includes recovery and restoration of services.
- Investigates incidents and identifies errors in products.
- Involves multiple teams across the organization.
- Can be automated and proactive, but also reactive when needed.
- Strong collaboration between teams is essential.



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Support: key definitions

Organizations face different types of issues, from minor errors to major disasters, and these are categorized to help support teams respond effectively.



Adapted from Figure 2.1 Changes are needed in all business situations (*ITIL Change Enablement* Official Practice Guide)

Disaster

A sudden unplanned event that causes great damage or serious loss to an organization. A disaster results in an organization failing to provide critical business functions for some predetermined minimum period of time.

Error

A flaw or vulnerability that may cause incidents.

Problem

A cause, or potential cause, of one or more incidents.

Known error

A problem that has been analysed but has not been resolved.

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Support: workflow

The high-level workflow of each 'support' activity comprises three steps:

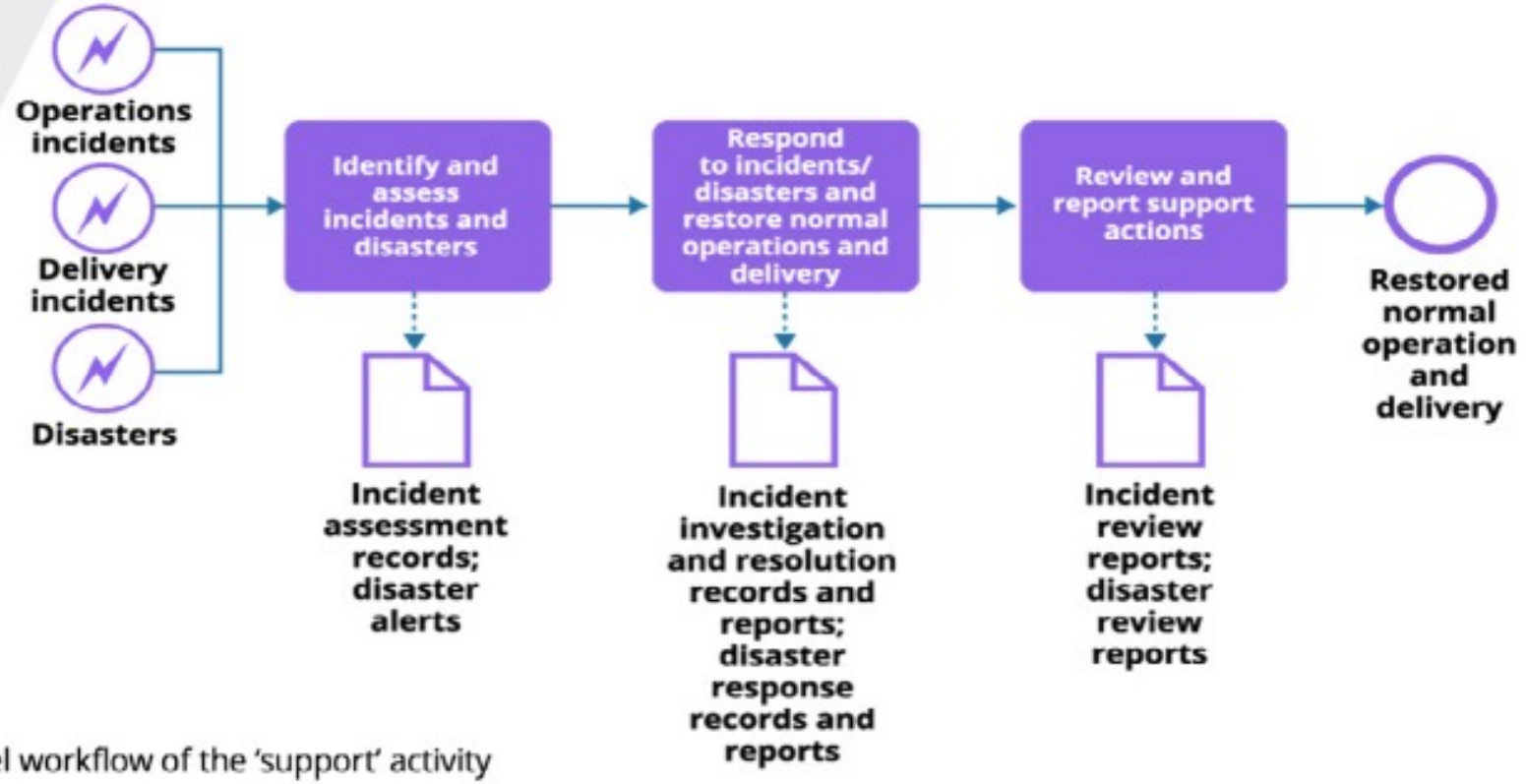


Figure 4.11 High-level workflow of the 'support' activity

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Support: roles and outputs

Roles

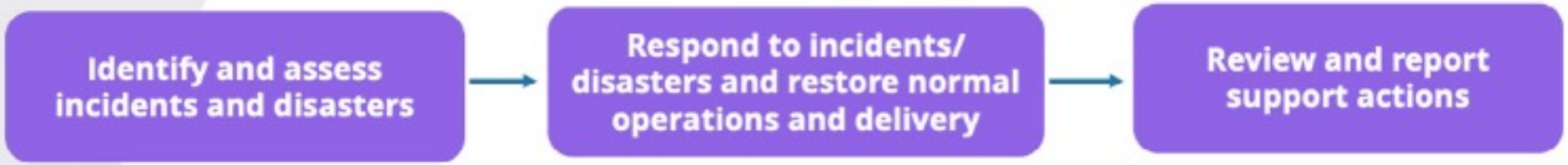
- Product teams.
- SRE teams.
- IT operations teams.
- User support teams.
- Service desk teams.
- Other specialized teams as needed.

Outputs

- Restored normal product operation and service delivery.

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Support: management practices



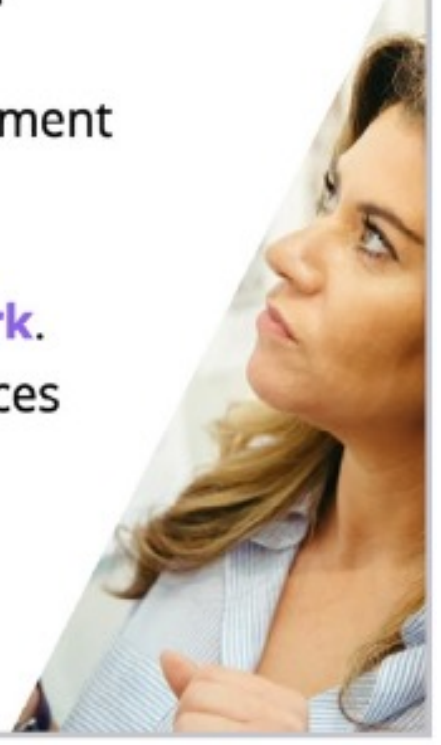
Enabling practices	
Change enablement	Problem management
Continual improvement	Relationship management
Deployment management	Release management
Incident management	Service catalogue management
Information security management	Service continuity management
Measurement and reporting	Service desk
Monitoring and event management	Service level management

Supporting practices	
Availability management	Service configuration management
Capacity and performance management	Service financial management
Infrastructure and platform management	Service validation and testing
IT asset management	Software development and management
Knowledge management	Supplier management
Risk management	

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Recap: Key learning points

- The **purpose** of the **value chain** is to **transform demand and opportunities** into value through **interconnected lifecycle management activities**.
- The ITIL Product and Service Lifecycle covers **discover, design, acquire, build, transition, operate, deliver, and support**.
- These **activities** are **flexible** and **adaptive**, not always sequential, and must align with organizational strategy and consumer needs.
- **Success** is **measured** by **metrics** such as stakeholder satisfaction, reliability, and alignment with roadmaps.
- **Management practices strengthen** and enable **each value chain activity**
- **Practices** provide the **methods and resources** that **make value chain activities work**.
- ITIL defines **34 management practices** in two groups: 12 general management practices and 22 product and service management practices.
- The ITIL Official Practice Guides share a **consistent structure** (Table 5.3) and deliver practical, effective guidance.



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Quiz

Questions:

1. What is the **MAIN** purpose of the ‘discover’ activity?
   A. To develop and test digital products
   B. To secure and allocate resources efficiently
   C. To align product capabilities with consumer needs and strategy
   D. To maintain and monitor digital products

2. Which of the following is **NOT** a success metric of the 'discover' activity?

   A. Strategic fit of the organization's products and service offerings

   B. Market relevance of the products and service offerings

   C. Service performance against the agreed SLA targets

   D. Stakeholder satisfaction with products and service offerings

3. Which activity focuses on minimizing the impact of incidents and disasters when they happen?

   A. Transition

   B. Operate

   C. Support

   D. Design